

Element C

Priority List for a good turtle environment

1. (High)Safe Environment: We do not want to hurt the turtle. We should make sure the environment is safe for the turtles. There will be nothing in the habitat that will be harmful for the turtles.
 - a. Just make sure to watch and monitor turtles that they don't have any weird or random abrasions due to environment
2. (High)Basking area with heat source: Turtles need to bask in the sun so they are able to metabolize the food they eat.
 - a. Monitor the temperature of the basking area. I saw with AI that it should be around 70-80 degrees F range but I am not sure on that.
3. (High)UV light bulb: This is linked with the basking area but turtles need UV light to help metabolize and also for calcium.
 - a. The light bulbs must be UV so the way we would measure this is checking on age of light bulb and verifying that they are UV
4. (High)Cleaning of the tank and water: Dirty water can cause shell rot and infection so clean water is definitely important.
 - a. One way to measure this is first watch how long it takes to get visibly dirty and to clean every of that time. For example, if it takes ten hours to see that the water is dirty , you can set the schedule of once every 10 hours. Also you can have cleaning logs.
5. (High)Adequate space: Turtles need enough space to move around. They need to have enough room eat, rest and bask without stress from being clustered.
 - a. For the basking area, 12 in x 18 in should be sufficient for the turtles. For the species we have, the females grow up to 12 inches and the males grow up to 7 inches.
6. Access to basking area: Turtles would need an efficient method of reaching basking area without too much struggle.
7. Food schedule: The turtles would need a food schedule so that they are being fed but not overfed.
 - a. You can have food logs to assure they are given adequate food. The turtles can also be monitored and measure to assure they are being well-nutritional.

We have interviewed our stakeholder and asked about what the turtles need. Some of the things they had mentioned turtles nutrition, turtle safety, cleanliness of the tanks, among other things. I made sure the requirements listed abided with the questions we had asked.